

ROBES OF WRATH

The military junta in Myanmar faced its most serious crisis ever when the highly-revered Buddhist monks took to the streets in thousands to protest against some of their brethren been beaten up and also a sharp rise in prices. For the junta, it was a dilemma since treating protesting monks in the same way it might treat dissidents and ordinary citizens risked provoking the public. The protests continued for some days but the bamboo curtain remained closed to outsiders and the fate of the protests—and the protesters—remained largely a matter of speculation.

AP



"We want national reconciliation,
we want dialogue with the military, we want
freedom for Suu Kyi and other political prisoners."

PROTEST LEADER AT YANGON RALLY